

news feed

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hypothesis

DATAPLAY

■ What is it?

A digital media storage format that lets you record any kind of digital content on it, be it music, games or images. You can then play it on any



device that is DataPlay enabled, which is, any device that incorporates the DataPlay micro-optical engine for recording and playing the media.

■ Why DataPlay?

It can record and play back any type of digital content, is just 32 mm across and sells for a mere \$10 (Rs 500) for a 500 MB blank media (also available in 250 MB capacity). It can be pre-recorded for mass distribution or can be recorded and customised by a consumer.

■ How do I start using it?

The DataPlay micro-optical engine is the player/recorder for DataPlay digital media. It's designed for easy integration into digital music players, digital cameras, PDAs, cell phones, etc. The micro-optical engine is about the size of a matchbox and features a 1 MBps transfer rate. You will be able to purchase DataPlay-enabled consumer electronics devices later this year.

United we stand!

Caldera, Turbolinux, Conectiva and SuSE have announced that they will merge their separate Linux products into a single version called UnitedLinux (www.unitedlinux.org) by the end of 2002. The com-



panies plan to share research costs and to make it easier for hardware and software companies to certify that their products are compatible with Linux. Conspicuous by their absence are Red Hat, the current top vendor for Linux, MandrakeSoft and Sun Microsystems.

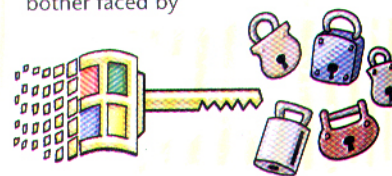
Linux was riding the popularity wave in the late 1990s and became prominent enough for Microsoft to sit up and take

notice. But things are different now. Several Linux start-ups such as Linuxcare have folded, and SuSE and Caldera have undergone massive restructuring. This precarious scenario gave birth to the formation of UnitedLinux.

UnitedLinux pools resources of these four vendors while giving much of the technological control to SuSE, simply because SuSE is the only Linux seller that has a development staff that's comparable to Red Hat's. The first version of UnitedLinux will basically be the next version of SuSE's advanced server edition, coupled with features provided by the other companies.

Microsoft extends the bridge of trust

Software giant Microsoft is developing a technology codenamed TrustBridge, which it claims will help reduce the bother faced by



workers in big companies having to go through several user authentications and passwords. This is also a move to compete against the Liberty Alliance Project which is backed by rival Sun Microsystems. The Alliance, launched in September 2001, now has more than 40 members, including United Airlines, Sony, Fidelity Investments and AOL Time Warner.

While Microsoft's existing Passport single sign-on ID system is targeted at consumers, with TrustBridge, business users will be able to log onto Windows-based systems (hosted locally or remotely at partner companies) by means of a single ID. The ID can be created through Passport, Active Directory or through any other ID system on any operating system that supports Kerberos, a network security standard.

Groove on the move

Want high quality amplified music on the move? Then take a look at the latest offering from Creative Technology. It has launched a portable speaker system with a difference—it comes with a digital amplifier built into it. Christened Creative TravelSound, it converts analogue inputs and amplifies them in the digital domain before converting the signal back into analogue to drive the speakers. The advantage of using a digital amplifier is that less heat is generated and the bat-



tery can be used more effectively. It also allows for a more compact form factor (the TravelSound weighs just 320 grams) and most importantly, high fidelity audio quality. You can use the TravelSound with portable CD and MP3 players and it is powered by just four AAA batteries.